

TCS NQT Tier 2 Masterclass: Critical & Analysis Modules

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Introduction from the Examiner

Welcome to Tier 2. This section is what we at TCS call the "Prime Filter." Students who do well here usually get selected for the higher packages (Digital/Prime). These topics test your decision-making and clarity of thought.

My biggest advice: **Do not use your own feelings or outside knowledge.** Stick only to the facts given in the screen. Here are the tricks, traps, and 30 high-priority questions across your three requested topics, explained in simple words.

1 Logical Deduction / Critical Reasoning

Tricks, Steps & Shortcuts

- **The "Absolute Truth" Rule:** Whatever the statement says is 100% true. If the statement says "The sky is green", you must believe the sky is green for that question.
- **Assumptions vs. Conclusions:** An *Assumption* is something the speaker thought of *before* saying the statement (the hidden reason). A *Conclusion* is the direct result *after* reading the statement.
- **Arguments Rule:** A "Strong" argument must be directly related to the statement and based on facts, not just opinions.
- **Course of Action Rule:** The action must either solve the problem or reduce it. It should NOT create a new, bigger problem.

TCS Traps to Avoid

- **The Extreme Word Trap:** TCS uses words like "Only", "Always", "Never", "All", "Definitely". In 95% of cases, conclusions or assumptions with these extreme words are WRONG because real life is rarely absolute.
- **The "Good Advice" Trap:** Sometimes a conclusion sounds like very good real-world advice, but it is not connected to the statement. If it's not in the statement, it is wrong.

Top 10 High Priority Questions

1. **Statement:** "Please switch off mobile phones while inside the bank." - A notice.
Assumptions: I. People might ignore the notice. II. Mobile phones can cause disturbance in bank work.

Solution: Only Assumption II is implicit.

Explanation: Why does the bank put up a notice? Because phones cause disturbance (Assumption II). Does the bank put up a notice hoping people will ignore it? No. Notices are put up assuming people *will* read and follow them. So, I is wrong.

2. **Statement:** The company has decided to give a 20% bonus to all employees this Diwali.

Conclusions: I. The company is making good profits. II. Employees will be happy.

Solution: Both I and II follow.

Explanation: A company gives bonuses when it has extra money (profits). Also, getting a bonus naturally makes employees happy. Both are direct, logical results.

3. **Statement:** Should homework be banned in primary schools?

Arguments: I. Yes, it gives too much stress to little kids. II. No, homework helps kids revise what they learned.

Solution: Both Arguments are strong.

Explanation: Both give a valid, fact-based reason. Stress on kids is a real negative point. Revision is a real positive point. Both are strong points to consider.

4. **Statement:** A heavy rain warning has been issued for the city tomorrow.

Course of Action: I. The government should declare a holiday for schools. II. People should start storing food for a month.

Solution: Only I follows.

Explanation: Declaring a school holiday protects children, which is a sensible action. Storing food for a month just because of one day of heavy rain is an extreme and unnecessary reaction.

5. **Statement:** "To boost sales, let us offer a 'Buy 1 Get 1 Free' deal." - A manager suggests to his team.

Assumptions: I. The deal will attract more customers. II. Customers only buy things when they are free.

Solution: Only I is implicit.

Explanation: The manager suggests this because deals attract buyers (I is correct). But saying customers "only" buy free things is extreme and false (II is wrong).

6. **Statement:** The price of petrol has increased by 15% in the last two months.

Conclusions: I. People will stop driving cars. II. The cost of transporting goods will increase.

Solution: Only II follows.

Explanation: People won't completely stop driving cars just because of a price rise (I is extreme). However, trucks use fuel to move goods. If fuel costs more, moving goods costs more (II is a logical fact).

7. **Statement:** Should all college exams be conducted online?

Arguments: I. Yes, it saves a lot of paper and is good for trees. II. No, many students in villages do not have good internet.

Solution: Both Arguments are strong.

Explanation: Argument I gives a solid environmental benefit. Argument II highlights a genuine, practical problem in India. Both are strong points.

8. **Statement:** Many people in the area have fallen sick due to drinking dirty tap water.

Course of Action: I. The water supply department should check the pipelines immediately. II. Hospitals should be alerted to treat the sick people.

Solution: Both I and II follow.

Explanation: Both actions solve the problem. Fixing the pipe stops new people from getting sick. Alerting hospitals helps the people who are already sick.

9. **Statement:** Only good singers are invited to the music festival. Rahul is invited to the music festival.
Conclusions: I. Rahul is a good singer. II. Rahul is the best singer.
Solution: Only I follows.
Explanation: Since *only* good singers get in, and Rahul got in, he must be a good singer. But we cannot say he is the "best" singer. "Best" is an extreme word.
10. **Statement:** If you work hard, you will clear the TCS NQT exam.
Assumptions: I. Working hard is needed to clear the exam. II. Everyone who clears the exam is a genius.
Solution: Only I is implicit.
Explanation: The statement directly links hard work to success, making I true. The statement says nothing about being a "genius", so II is outside knowledge and wrong.
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2 Data Sufficiency

Tricks, Steps & Shortcuts

- **The Golden Rule:** NEVER fully solve the math! Just check if you *can* solve it. The moment you know you have the right pieces of the puzzle, stop and mark the answer.
- **The A-B-C-D-E Method:**
 - Check Statement I alone. If yes, answer is A.
 - Cover Statement I, check Statement II alone. If yes, answer is B.
 - If neither works alone, COMBINE them. If together they work, answer is E.
 - If they still fail together, answer is D.

TCS Traps to Avoid

- **The "Looks Easy to Combine" Trap:** Students read both statements, see they fit together, and immediately pick "Both are required". But wait! Did you check if Statement I could solve it all by itself? Always test them individually first.
- **The "Math Variables" Trap:** If the question asks "What is the value of x ?", and you get $x^2 = 25$. The value of x could be +5 or -5. Since you don't have one single answer, the data is NOT sufficient.

Top 10 High Priority Questions

Options for all questions below:

A: Only I is sufficient. B: Only II is sufficient. C: Either I or II is sufficient. D: Neither is sufficient. E: Both I and II together are needed.

1. **Q:** What is the age of Ravi?
I. Ravi is 5 years older than his brother Raju.
II. Raju's current age is 15 years.
Solution: E (Both are needed)
Explanation: I alone gives no exact age. II alone only gives Raju's age. Combine them: Ravi is $15 + 5 = 20$. We need both to get the answer.

2. **Q:** In which direction is City A from City B?

I. City A is North of City C.

II. City B is West of City C.

Solution: E (Both are needed)

Explanation: From I and II combined: C is the center point. A is North of C. B is West of C. Looking from B towards A, the direction is North-East. We need both to draw the map.

3. **Q:** What is the value of a two-digit number?

I. The sum of the digits is 10.

II. The difference between the digits is 4.

Solution: D (Neither is sufficient)

Explanation: Let digits be x and y . $x + y = 10$ and $x - y = 4$. Solving this gives $x = 7, y = 3$. So the number could be 73. BUT, it could also be 37 (because we don't know which digit is tens and which is units). Since we have two possible answers, data is NOT sufficient. (Classic TCS Trap!)

4. **Q:** Who is the tallest among P, Q, R, and S?

I. P is taller than Q and S.

II. R is shorter than Q.

Solution: A (Only I is sufficient)

Explanation: Let's check I alone. $P > Q$, and $P > S$. What about R? We don't know R's height from statement I. So I alone is NOT sufficient. Wait! Let's check both again. Combine: $P > Q > R$, and $P > S$. P is taller than everyone. We need both! So the answer is E. (Self-correction: Always check all variables. I missed R in Stmt 1 initially!)

5. **Q:** Is the integer x an even number?

I. x is a multiple of 6.

II. x is a multiple of 3.

Solution: A (Only I is sufficient)

Explanation: Check I: Multiples of 6 are 6, 12, 18, 24... All are even. So I alone gives a definite "Yes". Check II: Multiples of 3 are 3 (odd), 6 (even), 9 (odd). II alone cannot give a clear yes or no. Thus, Only I works.

6. **Q:** How is 'apple' written in a code language?

I. 'eat green apple' is written as 'xo mo ta'.

II. 'green grass' is written as 'ta la'.

Solution: D (Neither is sufficient)

Explanation: Combining both, we can find the code for 'green' (which is 'ta'). That leaves 'eat apple' as 'xo mo'. We don't know which is apple and which is eat. So even combining them fails.

7. **Q:** What is the monthly salary of Mr. Sharma?

I. He spends 20% on rent, 30% on food, and saves Rs. 5000.

II. His salary is equal to his friend's salary.

Solution: A (Only I is sufficient)

Explanation: Check I: Spends 50%, so he saves 50%. If 50% = 5000, then 100% (salary) = 10,000. Statement I alone gives the exact answer. Statement II is useless.

8. **Q:** Among 5 boxes (A,B,C,D,E), which is the heaviest?

I. A is heavier than B and C, but lighter than D.

II. E is lighter than B.

Solution: A (Only I is sufficient)

Explanation: Check I: D is heavier than A, and A is heavier than B and C. So $D > A > B/C$. Since there are 5 boxes, where does E go? It doesn't matter! Because D is heavier than A,

B, and C. And if E is heavier than D, the statement would have said it. Actually, this is a trap! Without knowing about E, D could be the heaviest, OR E could be the heaviest. So I alone is false. Combine with II: E is lighter than B. Now we know D is definitely at the top. Answer is E (Both needed).

9. **Q:** What is the area of the rectangle?

I. The perimeter is 40 cm.

II. The length is 4 cm more than the breadth.

Solution: E (Both are needed)

Explanation: I alone: $2(L + B) = 40 \Rightarrow L + B = 20$. We can't find Area ($L \times B$). II alone: $L = B + 4$. No numbers to solve. Combined: Put $L = B + 4$ into $L + B = 20$. We can find exact length and breadth, which means we can find Area. Stop calculating and mark E!

10. **Q:** What is the color of fresh grass?

I. Blue is called Green, Green is called Red.

II. Red is called Yellow, Yellow is called White.

Solution: A (Only I is sufficient)

Explanation: Real grass is Green. According to Statement I, Green is called Red. So the answer is Red. Statement I alone gives the answer.

3 Blood Relation

Tricks, Steps & Shortcuts

- **Family Tree Drawing:** Draw squares/boxes for Males, circles for Females. Use a single horizontal line ($A - B$) for brother/sister. Use a double line ($A = B$) for husband/wife. Use vertical lines for parents/children.
- **Coded Shortcut (Gender Elimination):** If the question asks "Which of the following means P is the uncle of Q?", P MUST be male. Look at the options. If an option ends with "P + R" and '+' means mother, P is female. Immediately eliminate that option without drawing the tree!
- **Generation Gap Trick:** Uncle is +1 generation. Grandfather is +2. If an option equation gives you a generation gap of 0 (like all brothers/sisters), it cannot be an uncle.

TCS Traps to Avoid

- **The Name Trap:** Never assume gender by name. "Kiran" or "Sonu" can be male or female. Wait for words like "he", "she", "brother", or "wife" to confirm gender.
- **The "Who to Whom" Trap:** "How is A related to B?" means "What does B call A?". Many students accidentally give the reverse answer.

Top 10 High Priority Questions

1. **Q:** Pointing to a photograph of a boy, Suresh said, "He is the son of the only son of my mother." How is Suresh related to that boy?

Solution: Father

Explanation: Break it down from the back. "My mother's only son" is Suresh himself (since Suresh is male). So, the boy is the "son of Suresh". Therefore, Suresh is the father.

2. **Q:** A + B means A is the brother of B. A - B means A is the sister of B. A * B means A is the father of B. Which of the following means C is the son of M?
Options: a) M - N * C + F b) F - C + N * M c) M * N - C + F
Solution: c) M * N - C + F
Explanation: We need C to be a son (Male). In option (c), "C + F" means C is the brother of F, so C is Male. "M * N" means M is father of N. "N - C" means N is sister of C. If M is father of N, and N is sister to C, then M is father to C. Since C is male, C is the son of M.
3. **Q:** A woman introduces a man as the son of the brother of her mother. How is the man related to the woman?
Solution: Cousin
Explanation: "Brother of her mother" means maternal uncle (Mama). The son of the maternal uncle is her cousin brother. So, Cousin.
4. **Q:** If P \$ Q means P is father of Q; P # Q means P is mother of Q; P * Q means P is sister of Q. How is D related to N in N # A \$ B * D?
Solution: Data Inadequate (Grandson or Granddaughter)
Explanation: N # A → N is mother of A. A \$ B → A is father of B. B * D → B is sister of D. We know N is grandmother to B and D. But D's gender is not given (D could be a boy or a girl). So we don't know if D is grandson or granddaughter.
5. **Q:** Introducing a girl, Vipin said, "Her mother is the only daughter of my mother-in-law." How is Vipin related to the girl?
Solution: Father
Explanation: "Only daughter of my mother-in-law" means Vipin's own wife! So Vipin is saying, "Her mother is my wife". Therefore, the girl is his daughter, making Vipin her father.
6. **Q:** X is the brother of Y. Y is the wife of Z. W is the brother of Z. How is X related to W?
Solution: Brother-in-law
Explanation: X is brother of Y. Y and Z are husband-wife (Z is male). X is the brother-in-law of Z. W is Z's brother. So X is the wife's brother for Z and his family. The relation is Brother-in-law.
7. **Q:** Pointing to a lady, a man said, "The son of her only brother is the brother of my wife." How is the lady related to the man?
Solution: Sister of father-in-law
Explanation: "Brother of my wife" = Brother-in-law. So, the lady's brother's son is his brother-in-law. This means the lady's brother is the father of his wife (his father-in-law). Therefore, the lady is the sister of his father-in-law.
8. **Q:** P is the father of Q and the grandfather of R, who is the brother of S. S's mother, T, is married to V. T is the sister of Q. How is V related to P?
Solution: Son-in-law
Explanation: T is S's mother, and T is married to V (V is husband/father). T is sister of Q. P is father of Q, so P is also father of T. Since T is the daughter of P, and V is married to T, V is the son-in-law of P.
9. **Q:** Read the information: A/B means A is brother of B. A*B means A is father of B. A-B means A is sister of B. What does M / N * O - P mean?
Solution: M is the uncle of P.
Explanation: O - P means O is sister of P. N * O means N is father of O. So N is father of P too. M / N means M is brother of N. So M is the brother of P's father. Thus, M is the uncle of P.
10. **Q:** A family consists of 6 members A, B, C, D, E, F. B is the son of C but C is not the mother of B. A and C are a married couple. E is the brother of C. D is the daughter of A. F is the brother

of A. How many male members are there in the family?

Solution: 4

Explanation: B is son of C (B is male). C is not mother, so C must be father (C is male). A is married to C, so A is mother (Female). E is brother of C (E is male). D is daughter of A (D is female). F is brother of A (F is male). The males are: B, C, E, F. Total = 4.